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> advice and must not be relied upon as the sole basis for any decision or filing.

Analysis of Competing Hypotheses — Why is the injury date inconsistent?

Question: What best explains the claimant's injury date differing across the intake form, recorded statement, and physician note in claim CL-2291?
Method: Analysis of Competing Hypotheses (Heuer, *Psychology of Intelligence Analysis*, 1999) — evidence rated for consistency against each hypothesis; the hypothesis with the fewest inconsistencies is preferred.
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Hypotheses

H1. Transcription error at intake
H2. Claimant's recollection genuinely changed
H3. Deliberate misrepresentation

Consistency matrix

Evidence	H1	H2	H3	Diagnostic
Physician note date matches the medical record _(investigator's note — uncited: med-record.pdf)_	C	N	N	✓
Intake form was hand-keyed from a phone call _(investigator's note — uncited: intake-form.pdf)_	CC	C	I	✓
Claimant volunteered the discrepancy unprompted _(investigator's note — uncited: statement.m4a)_	C	C	II	✓
No financial motive found in the file _(investigator's note — uncited: financials)_	N	N	II	✓

Assessment coverage: 12 of 12 cells rated.

Inconsistency scores (fewest = most robust)

1. H1 — Transcription error at intake: **0** inconsistency points (4 of 4 cells rated)
2. H2 — Claimant's recollection genuinely changed: **0** inconsistency points (4 of 4 cells rated)
3. H3 — Deliberate misrepresentation: **5** inconsistency points (4 of 4 cells rated)

What the ratings establish: H1, H2 tie at 0 inconsistency points; no preference is established between them.

Legend: CC very consistent · C consistent · N neutral · I inconsistent · II very inconsistent · — unassessed. Only I/II count against a hypothesis; an unassessed cell counts for nothing and is not neutral.

Critical assumptions

- The medical record itself is authentic and correctly dated.

Indicators to watch

- A second altered document would raise the misrepresentation hypothesis.

Analyst's assessment (opinion)

The matrix and scores above are the evidence and its rating; the assessment below is the analyst's judgement drawn from them.

Leading hypothesis: Transcription error at intake
Confidence: Moderate

The evidence is least inconsistent with a transcription error at intake; misrepresentation is heavily contradicted by the unprompted disclosure and absence of motive. Recommend a targeted re-interview before any coverage decision.

ACH aids judgment; it does not compute a verdict. A low score means a hypothesis survives the evidence best, not that it is proven — if several remain viable, say so.

Appendix — Document history (audit trail)

- 24 Aug 2026 at 7:58 PM — Worked example created

Cited instruments are those named in this workflow (see the SOP register in the app). Procedures are jurisdiction-neutral; citations may need adapting locally. Any authorized deviation is recorded on the conformance certificate.